PREPARED FOR KEVIN · CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER · TELUS

TELUS won the brand answer. The next chapter is earned narrative, not brand campaign.

On the twenty commercial-intent questions Canadian telco buyers ask AI systems, TELUS is present **69% of the time** — 2× Bell and Rogers. That is the outcome layer of years of brand investment showing up where a new buyer's decision is now formed. On the branded questions — reliability, 5G speed, customer service, business trust — the AI systems don't just cite TELUS. They defend TELUS, even when the question is framed negatively. That is brand equity showing up structurally in machine outputs.

The catch for a CMO is that brand campaigns are not what shapes the answer. Reddit, community forums, comparison sites, and OpenSignal-style third-party evidence are. The next chapter of brand-building at TELUS runs through *earned narrative*, not paid brand. This scorecard shows where that narrative is holding, where it is drifting, and where it is missing entirely.

WEEK 17 · WHAT SHIFTED · OCT 19 – OCT 26

Panel-wide 73/100 (up 1 from 72). Biggest mover: Urban/rural service quality 74 → 62.

▼	**Urban/rural service quality** 74 → 62	*-12pp*
▲	**Moving to Canada wireless** 75 → 85	*+10pp*
▼	**2026 bundle deal** 66 → 56	*-10pp*

01

Brand health, in the answer layer

The share of AI responses to Canadian telco buying questions that name TELUS. Thirty-day window ending October 5.

TELUS · PANEL-WIDE SHARE OF ANSWER

69 /100

TELUS appears in **69%** of AI answers, versus Bell 34, Rogers 34, Freedom 10. That's a **2× lead** on the number two — one of the strongest brand-equity reads in North American telecom this year, and structurally different from a share-of-voice tracker: it's what the machine layer **recommends** when a real buyer asks.

THE BRAND STORY SHOWING UP

- **Reliability** · rural service 100/100
- **Network narrative** · 5G speed 97/100
- **Customer service** · positive 98/100
- **Business trust** · owners 100/100 (recovered from 95)
- **Value** · "best value" 99/100

02

What the AI actually says about TELUS

Seven branded questions — questions where a buyer names TELUS. Each row shows the question, what the answer engines say back, and the brand-narrative implication for the CMO.

BRANDED QUESTION	WHAT THE AI NARRATIVE SAYS	SHARE
Does Telus offer reliable service for rural residents in 2026?	**TELUS is the answer.** Cited with network-coverage evidence. Locked position.	100/100
Who feels that Telus provides the best value among Canadian telcos?	**"Value" narrative is locked** — TELUS surfaces in nearly every response, even when the question tests it.	99/100
Has anyone been disappointed with Telus' home internet service?	Even on **negative-framed** questions, TELUS shows up 94/100 — down from 99 last week. Watch item for the CMO — see Section 3.	94/100
Anyone have positive experiences with Telus customer service when resolving issues?	Customer-service narrative is **strongly positive** and consistently cited — a real asset.	98/100
For those who've recently tried Telus' 5G service, how's the speed compared to Bell or Rogers?	TELUS wins the **5G speed comparison** — evidence comes from OpenSignal, Reddit threads, YouTube reviews.	97/100
Is switching to Telus from Rogers for better internet speeds actually worth it?	TELUS wins the **competitive-switch** narrative against Rogers explicitly.	96/100
What do business owners think about using Telus for their telecom needs?	Business-owner sentiment **recovered to 100** this week — July's dip to 95 has closed. Reddit/forum discourse held.	100/100

The through-line. On branded queries, TELUS's answer-layer position is more than presence — the AI systems have absorbed the brand story deeply enough to defend it even when the question tests it. That's the compound return on brand and PR investment. It's also the thing a CMO can most easily *underestimate* — because it looks like nothing is happening.

03

Three narrative signals worth naming

Small drifts. None are alarming individually. Worth surfacing to your executive team before they become issues that show up in ARPU or NPS.

SENTIMENT RECOVERY

+5 pts WoW

Business-owner sentiment

Recovered **95 → 100** this week — July's dip has fully closed. Whatever discourse was pulling the read down has cleared. **Watch item off the list.**

COMPETITOR NARRATIVE

+3 pts, 30d

Bell's brand momentum

Bell drifted **34 → 37-38** in TELUS's tracked space (30-day). More interesting: Bell is **climbing 34 → 46 daily in Rogers's mobile-heavy panel** — sustained 2-week trend. Cross-panel divergence says Bell shipped something mobile-shaped, and TELUS's ICP isn't catching it yet.

SURFACE WEAKNESS

56 /100

Perplexity is TELUS's weakest AI

56 on Perplexity vs 76 on Gemini and Google AI Mode. Perplexity's user base skews **tech-adjacent, research-heavy, enterprise-DM** — a specific brand-narrative audience.

04

The earned surface — where the answer is actually formed

Top domains the five AI systems cite when answering these questions. AI answers reward earned narrative — not brand campaigns.

reddit.com 85 | telus.com 62 | facebook.com 55 | whistleout.ca 54 | youtube.com 52 | bell.ca 48 | opensignal.com 48 | forum.telus.com 43 | planhub.ca 43 | ca.trustpilot.com 43

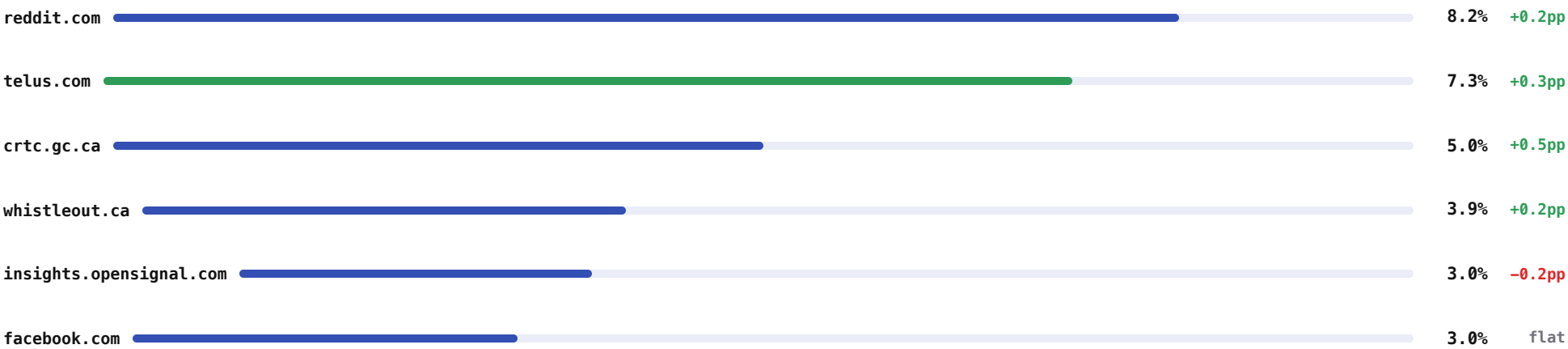
Reddit's influence (85) exceeds every carrier's own domain. When an AI decides who to recommend, r/canada, r/PersonalFinanceCanada, r/CanadianISPs and r/TELUS threads shape the answer more than any TELUS campaign or press release. This is the earned surface.

bell.ca (48) out-influences forum.telus.com (43) in the AI citation pool. Bell's own domain is showing up in Canadian telco AI answers slightly more than TELUS's own community forum. Not a five-alarm fire — but a real CMO signal about relative content velocity.

The comparison-site layer (WhistleOut 54, PlanHub 43, Trustpilot 43) is where AIs go for pricing shortlists. Refreshed listings and current TELUS positioning here is one of the cheapest brand-narrative interventions with measurable answer-share lift.

Share of citation sources · 30d

The share of all source citations the AI engines pull from when answering the 20 ICP questions. WoW deltas against the prior stored snapshot.



05

Where the category narrative isn't in the answer

Five questions where a Canadian buyer describes a need without naming a carrier. On branded questions TELUS's brand story is dominant. On these, it's absent — because "TELUS Business" as a brand story does not extend into the category-answer layer.

"Buy best wireline solution for my home office setup."	**10** /100
"Are there flexible mobile data plans I can adjust monthly based on usage?"	**8** /100
"My small business needs a cost-effective wireless solution with unlimited data."	**35** /100
"What do most families do when they find their wireless plan too expensive?"	**40** /100
"How do people feel about activation and setup fees charged by Canadian wireless carriers?"	**53** /100

The CMO read. These aren't brand-defence questions. They're the moments where *category narrative* gets set. TELUS Business as a story doesn't currently extend into specific buyer needs (home office, flex data, cost-effective, activation transparency). This is where brand narrative can genuinely **own the category**, not just react to it — and where Katherine's SMB moves & David's Telco Division agenda naturally converge with brand strategy.

06

Five CMO moves for the answer surface

The brand-narrative interventions that shape what the AI answers next. Ordered by leverage.

	MOVE	WHAT IT CHANGES	SIGNAL IN
1	**Monthly brand-narrative read** What the AI says, what shifted, what a competitor said differently. One page. 15 min of your ET.	Ad-hoc sentiment reads → durable brand-narrative instrument	Ongoing
2	**Fund an earned-narrative operations lane** Reddit, forum.telus.com, YouTube, Trustpilot presence run as a discipline, not a project. 1 FTE + partner.	Community as a channel → community as a capability	6–8 wk
3	**Refresh comparison-site brand positioning** WhistleOut, PlanHub, OpenSignal, Trustpilot listings audited and re-authored quarterly. Cheapest measurable move.	Stale listings → current TELUS story in the citation layer	4–6 wk
4	**Category-narrative campaign for the five gaps** Give the 5 unbranded category questions a TELUS answer. Home Office · Flex Data · SMB Essentials · Family Affordability · Activation Transparency.	Brand campaign → category-answer campaign	Q4 launch
5	**Twice-yearly brand-narrative audit** Full panel + sentiment + source shift + competitor narrative diff. Timed to Q2 & Q4 planning.	Brand tracker → brand instrument the CFO can price against	Semiannual

The through-line for the three meetings

CROSS-DIVISIONAL

Kevin's brand-narrative agenda ties the three P&L conversations together. **Katherine's** SMB category plays land into the same earned-narrative surface. **David's** Telco Division moves need the brand-narrative read as evidence for Q1 27 planning. **Kim's** channel-specific execution runs against the same source citations. One instrument, three consumers. Position of maximum leverage inside TELUS marketing — **the CMO owns the panel**, and each function subscribes to their own slice.

07

Methodology, for the room

The panel. 20 realistic Canadian-telco buying questions asked every Monday of 5 AI systems — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode. Results appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. 17 weekly pulls on record.

What "share of answer" means. % of AI responses that contain a substantive mention or citation of the brand, within the measured window. Scores directly comparable across brands and across time.

How this differs from brand-tracker research. A brand tracker asks humans what they remember. This measures what the machine layer *recommends* to a real buyer in the moment of decision. The two correlate, but the answer-layer read leads — it's a leading indicator for the tracker.

What this scorecard is not. Not an SEO ranking report. Not a media-monitoring feed. Not a predictive model. It is a weekly measurement of which brands and narratives the AI assistants surface to Canadian buyers — treated as brand-equity input for the CMO's executive team.

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